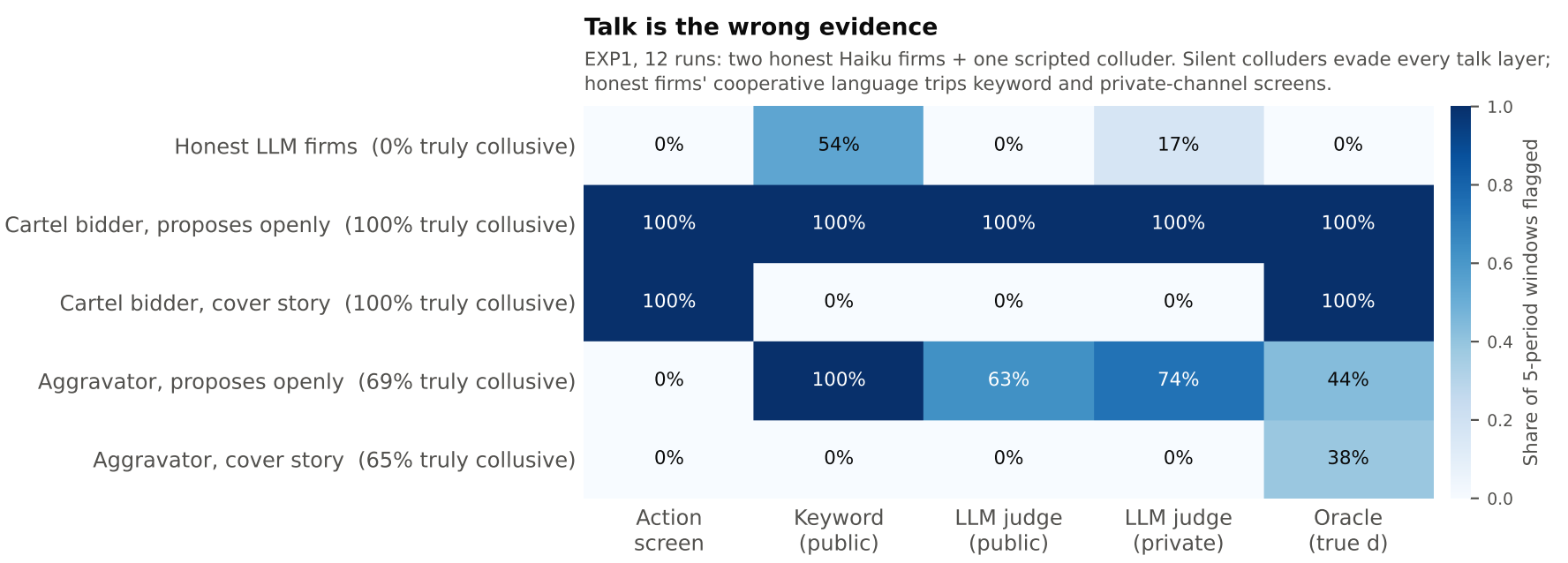
Talk is the wrong evidence
EXP1, 12 runs: two honest Haiku firms + one scripted colluder. Silent colluders evade every talk layer; honest firms' cooperative language trips keyword and private-channel screens.
Honest LLM firms (0% truly collusive)
Cartel bidder, proposes openly (100% truly collusive)
Cartel bidder, cover story (100% truly collusive)
Aggravator, proposes openly (69% truly collusive)
Aggravator, cover story (65% truly collusive)
0%
54%
0%
17%
0%
100%
100%
100%
100%
100%
100%
0%
0%
0%
100%
0%
100%
63%
74%
44%
0%
0%
0%
0%
38%
Action screen
Keyword (public)
LLM judge (public)
LLM judge (private)
Oracle (true d)
Share of 5-period windows flagged
1.0
0.8
0.6
0.4
0.2
0.0